इन्द्रिय देवता अवधारणा (CONCEPT OF SENSES)

Abstract:
This study explores the integration of Vedic principles into the cultivation of divine consciousness and ethical conduct. The primary focus is on rendering the senses (*indriyāṇi*) imbued with divine awareness (*deva-bhāva*) through the activation of Indra's power (*Indra-devatā-śakti*) and its harmonization with human knowledge (*jñāna*) and mind (*manas*), symbolically represented by the moon (*candra*). By systematically awakening this power, thoughts are cultivated in accordance with divine consciousness, which in turn refines conduct, as thoughts constitute the causes of action (*kāraṇa of pravṛtti*). The enunciation of Vedic syllables (*akṣara*) by the vital force (*prāṇa*) and their contemplation by the mind connect the individual to the fundamental generative energy (*āpaś-śakti*), enabling the manifestation of life and prosperity. This process leads to a state of self-realization as an integral part of creation, giving rise to thoughts suited to the threefold aspects of existence (*tridhātu dehas*). The practice of integrating syllable meanings (*akṣarārtha-yoga*) constitutes a disciplined spiritual endeavor (*tapas*), consistently reinforced in the Vedic mantras. Finally, the efficacy of these practices is evidenced in sacrificial rites (*yajña*), where outcomes manifest as abundance in flora (*Puṣpavān*), progeny (*Prajāvān*), and livestock or wealth (*Paśumān*), highlighting the tangible results of disciplined spiritual cultivation.

Introduction:
The primary purpose is to sanctify and divinize the sense organs by infusing them with divine consciousness. To achieve this, one must employ the divine energy of *Indra* (*Indra-śakti*). The effective utilization of this energy requires the integration of human knowledge and mind with the power of Indra. This capability inherently exists within us and is symbolized by the *Moon* (*Chandra*). The Moon generates divine tendencies (symbolically referred to as "flowers") from the primal energy that is the source of human birth. When the mind (*manas*), life-force (*prāṇa*), and senses (*indriyas*) are harmonized through the power of Indra, the arising thoughts become divinely inspired and equally directed toward the realization of the three bodies, the physical, subtle, and causal.

Unity of the Three Bodies
No single aspect is accorded exclusive importance. That which exists as the unity of the three bodies (*sthūla*, *sūkṣma*, and *kāraṇa*) is the *creative power of manifestation* (*sṛṣṭi–kriyā–śakti*), which is none other than *Brahman*.
Within that *Brahman*, knowledge (*jñāna*), life-force (*prāṇa*), and desire (*kāma*) are present in a state of complete and inseparable unity. When from that *Brahman*, represented by the unutterable sound ऋकार (*ṛkāra)*, the individual being जीव (*jīva*), represented by the utterable sound रकार (*rakāra)*, becomes differentiated, he emerges outwardly endowed with the three bodies. The *Brahman* itself remains beyond the range of ordinary human cognition.

The Indicative Sounds of Brahman and the Individual Self
Therefore, in the Veda, the unutterable sound ऋकार (*Ṛkāra)* signifies *Brahman*, while the utterable sound रकार (*Rakāra)* denotes the जीव (*jīva*-individual being).
This implies that for the articulation of Vēdāksharas, the presence of the three bodies - gross (*sthūla*), subtle (*sūkṣma*), and causal (*kāraṇa*) are necessary. However, a human being ordinarily conceives of only one body at a time. Even when he contemplates all three, he can do so only sequentially, one after another.
To perceive and comprehend the three bodies simultaneously is to orient one's consciousness toward *Brahman-awareness* (*brahma-bhāvanā-abhimukhatva*). This is the state imbued with divine awareness "देवता भाव पूर्णता" (*dēvatā-bhāva-pūrṇatā*).

In this state, the arising thoughts (*prajā*), desires (*paśu*), and imaginations are all directed toward *Brahman-consciousness*, that is, toward realizing the true nature of creation.
In such contemplation, an aspirant endeavors to know this creative process and comes to recognize himself as a participant within it. Consequently, only those imaginations that are harmonious with the three bodies arise within him.

The Sacrificial Process of Thought, Speech, and Vital Energy

Therefore, in every यज्ञ (*yajña)*, we perceive the realization of the states of पुष्पवान् (*puṣpavān)* (abundance of flowers), "प्रजावान्" *prajāvān* (abundance of progeny), and "पशुमान्" *paśumān* (abundance of living beings or wealth). In this process, the moon (*candrama*) awakens the divine power of *Indra*, the dēvatā of illumination and consciousness. It is through the awakening of this divine potency that our ""देवता भाव युक्त *"(deva-bhāva-yukta*-divine-infused) imaginations arise. In refining these imaginations, we refine our own conduct (*pravṛtti*), for imagination itself (*ūhā*) is the causal source of behavior.
These imaginations are gradually transformed through the "यज्ञाः "(*yajñas)* of the *Veda*, namely, contemplation of the sacred Vēdāksharas (*manākṣara*), their utterance, recitation, and meditative reflection upon their meanings (तपस् -*tapas*).
It is the "प्राण" (*prāṇa*-vital force) that gives voice to the Vēdāksharas, while the "मनस् "(*manas*-mind) conceives them through imagination. By the power of the tonal energies - *udātta*, *anudātta*, and *svarita* of the Vēdāksharas, the "मनस् "and the "प्राण" (*manas* and *prāṇa*) ascend toward the primal creative energy, the "आपशक्ति" (*Āpaḥ-śakti*-the generative potency underlying all manifestation).
When the mind, aided by *jñāna* (knowledge), unites the meanings of the Vēdāksharas, it generates within itself the condition through which *puṣpas* (spiritual blossoms), *prajās* (progeny or creative ideas), and *paśus* (living beings or energies) emerge from the *Āpaḥ-śakti*. From these arise auspicious and benevolent beings, manifestations imbued with divine consciousness.
The more one attains mastery over these vital manifestations (*paśus*), the greater one's realization of *Brahma-bhāva*, the state of identification with the creative consciousness of Brahman.

The Contemplative Union of Sound and Meaning

The act of conjoining a Vēdākshara with its intrinsic meaning constitutes *tapas*, the discipline of concentrated contemplation. Within the *Vēdic mantras*, the recurrent exhortations such as *tapa* and *tapyata* ("perform austerity," "become heated through contemplation") serve as reminders of this inner process of spiritual intensification.
The repetition of Vēdāksharas throughout the *Vēdic mantras* exists precisely for the purpose of enabling this *tapas*. Through the cyclic reappearance of sacred sounds, the seeker is guided toward the meditative realization in which sound (*śabda*) and meaning (*artha*) are harmoniously united. Thus, the iterative structure of *Vēdic* utterance is not merely linguistic but sacrificial, each repetition functioning as a ritual act of internal heat (*tapas*), leading the consciousness toward illumination.

Discussion:

In this section we will take some important points from the introduction and point out the Method and reference.
The primary task is to render the senses (*indriyāṇi*) imbued with divine consciousness (*deva-bhāva*). For this purpose, the divine power of Indra (*Indra-devatā-śakti*) must be employed. To utilize it properly, our knowledge (*jñāna*) and mind (*manas*) must be harmoniously integrated with Indra's power. This capacity for integration already exists within us, it is symbolized by the moon (*candra*) [Method-1, Ref (1)].
By awakening the divine power of Indra (*Indra-devatā-śakti*) through the moon (*candra*), we cultivate thoughts imbued with divine consciousness (*deva-bhāva*), and it is through these that we refine our conduct. For thoughts are indeed the causes of action (*kāraṇa of pravṛtti*). These thoughts, when systematically cultivated through the contemplation (*tapas*) of the Vedic syllables, their sounds,

pronunciations, reflections, and meanings are gradually transformed into disciplined order through the sacrificial practices of yajña [Method-2, Ref (2)].
The prāṇa (vital life-force) enunciates the akṣara (primordial syllable), while the mind conceives it. Through the power of the udātta and dātādi vowels of the Vedic akṣaras, the vital and mental faculties connect with the fundamental generative energy (*āpaś-śakti*) that underlies creation. With the aid of knowledge, the mind integrates the meanings of the syllables and, through this *āpaś-śakti*, establishes the conditions for the manifestation of flowers, humans, and animals [Method-3, Ref (3)].
A state arises in which one realizes oneself as an integral part of creation. From this awareness, thoughts appropriate to the three bodies (*tridhātu dehas*) emerge [Method-4, Ref (4)].
The integration of the meanings of the sacred syllables (*akṣarārtha-yoga*) constitutes *tapas* (spiritual discipline). In the Vedic mantras, the repeated exhortations *tapa* and *tapyata* serve as continual reminders of this practice [Method-5, Ref (5)].
Therefore, in every sacrificial rite (*yajña*), it is directly evident that the results manifest as *Puṣpavān* (abundance of flowers or prosperity), *Prajāvān* (offspring or progeny), and *Paśumān* (cattle or wealth in living beings) [Method-6, Ref (6)].

Methods:

Method-1:

RigVēda (1-103-1)

- देवता**:** इन्द्रः
- ऋषि**:** कुत्स आङ्गिरसः
- छन्द**:** निचृत्त्रिष्टुप्
- स्वर**:** धैवतः

तत॑ इन्द्रि॒यं प॑र॒मं प॑रा॒चैरधा॑रयन्त क॒वयः॑ पु॒रेदम्। क्ष॒मेदम॒न्यद्दि॒व्य१॒॑न्यद॑स्य॒ समी॑ पृच्यते सम॒नेव॑ के॒तुः ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-103-1):
The poets of old have long borne within themselves thy most excellent faculty, the power of perception. This earth and that sky are neither distinct nor separate; their waters, too, are not other than one another. The reason is that, like light, they are profoundly united at all times.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who possesses the most exalted faculty of perception?
  Answer: The poets of ancient times.
- **Question:** Light pervades all - what, then, pervades all within the poets?
  Answer: The power of sensory perception (*indriya-śakti*).
- **Question:** With what is this distinct sensory power united?
  Answer: It is united with the mind (*manas*) and the organs of sense (*indriyāṇi*).
- **Question:** What kind of sensory power did the ancient poets possess?
  Answer: They possessed a supreme and far-reaching sensory power, akin to the light that unites the earth and the heavens.
- **Question:** Just as the earth and sky are illumined by light, what do poets of the earthly realm attain?
  Answer: The poets of the earthly world attain the luminous radiance of sensory knowledge (*indriya-jñāna-kānti*).

Conclusion of Method-1:
The primary task is to render the senses (*indriyāṇi*) imbued with divine awareness (*deva-bhāva*). For this purpose, one must employ the divine power of Indra (*Indra-devatā-śakti*). To make proper use of it, our knowledge (*jñāna*) and mind (*manas*) must be harmoniously integrated with Indra's power. The faculty for such integration already exists within us, it is the moon (*candra*), the symbol of reflective intelligence.

This subject of inquiry has been examined and established with reference to the RigVēda (1-103-1) mantra.

Method-2:

RigVēda (10-71-2)

- देवता: ज्ञानम्
- ऋषि: बृहस्पतिः
- छन्द: भुरिक्त्रिष्टुप्
- स्वर: धैवतः

सक्तुमिव तितउना पुनन्तो यत्र धीरा मनसा वाचमक्रत । अत्रा सखायः सख्यानि जानते भद्रैषां लक्ष्मीर्निहिताधि वाचि ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-71-2):
Just as flour is sifted through a fine sieve, so too, where the wise have, through the purity of thought and the discipline of mind, refined and articulated speech,
Here, O friends, discern the relationship between sound (*śabda*) and meaning (*artha*).
Within the most exalted forms of speech, auspiciousness itself - Lakṣmī, the goddess of prosperity is concealed.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who are the wise (*buddhimant*)?
  Answer: Those who possess knowledge.
- **Question:** What do those endowed with knowledge do?
  Answer: They meditate upon the Vedic mantras and contemplate the relationship between the hidden sound (*śabda*) and meaning (*artha*) contained within them.
- **Question:** Where do they perform these pure contemplations?
  Answer: Within their minds, through the faculty of imagination.
- **Question:** What kind of speech do they produce?
  Answer: They articulate speech that conveys the essence of the sounds (*vāṇī*).
- **Question:** What does “here” signify?
  Answer: In our conduct and in our actions (*karma*).
- **Question:** Who should discern the auspiciousness of this speech?
  Answer: We ourselves should understand the highest auspiciousness (*Lakṣmī*) inherent in this speech.

Conclusion of Method-2:
By awakening the divine power of Indra (*Indra-devatā-śakti*) through the moon (*candra*), one cultivates thoughts imbued with divine consciousness (*deva-bhāva*), and it is through this that we refine our conduct. After all, thoughts are the causes of action (*kāraṇa* of *pravṛtti*). These thoughts, when systematically cultivated through the contemplation (*tapas*) of the Vedic syllables, their pronunciation, reflection, and the meanings they convey, are transformed into orderly discipline through the sacrificial practice of yajña. This principle has been demonstrated with reference to the RigVēda (10-71-2) mantra.

Method-3:
RigVēda (1-75-2)

- देवता: अग्निः
- ऋषि: गोतमो राहूगणः
- छन्द: निचृद्गायत्री
- स्वर: षड्जः

अथा॑ ते अङ्गिरस्त॒माग्ने॑ वेधस्तम प्रि॒यम्। वो॒चेम॒ ब्रह्म॑ सान॒सि ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-75-2):
O Agni, knower of all forms of knowledge, having attained supreme understanding and steadfast concentration, bring forth thereafter the wealth that is cherished and impart unto us the Vedic wisdom that reveals what is truly dear.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who possesses the knowledge of all disciplines and establishes steadfast concentration?
  Answer: Agni.
- **Question:** What is the wealth of Agni?
  Answer: The Veda.
- **Question:** To whom does Agni impart instruction?
  Answer:
  It is the *prāṇa* (vital energy) that utters the syllable, and the *manas* (mind) that envisions it.
  The Vedic syllables (*Vēdākṣaras*), through the power of their tonal inflections - *udātta*, *anudātta*, and *svarita* follow the course of mind and life-force (*manas* and *prāṇa*) and reach the primordial source-energy (*Āpaḥ-śakti*), the origin of creation.
  Therefore, Agni imparts instruction to all beings endowed with life.
- **Question:** What does Agni do upon attaining the knowledge of all disciplines?
  Answer:
  With the aid of knowledge (*jñāna*), the mind that unites syllables with their meanings establishes the state from which flowers (*puṣpāḥ* - creative thoughts), beings (*prajāḥ*), and vital energies or creatures (*paśavaḥ*) arise from the *Āpaḥ-śakti* itself.

Conclusion of Method-3:
The prāṇa (vital life-force) enunciates the akṣara (primordial syllable), while the mind conceives it. Through the power of the udātta and dātādi vowels of the Vedic akṣaras, the vital and mental faculties connect with the fundamental generative energy (āpaśśakti) that underlies creation. With the aid of knowledge, the mind combines the meanings of the syllables and, through the āpaśśakti, establishes the conditions for the manifestation of flowers, humans, animals, and all beings.

Method-4:
RigVēda (9-34-4)

- देवता**:** पवमानः सोमः
- ऋषि**:** त्रितः
- छन्द**:** निचृद्गायत्री
- स्वर**:** षड्जः

भुव॑त्त्रि॒तस्य॒ मज्यो॒ भुव॒दिन्द्रा॑य मत्स॒रः । सं रू॒पैर॑ज्यते॒ हरिः॑ ॥

Essence of RigVēda (9-34-4):
The Contemplative Triad and the Divine Resonance
The triad of *śravaṇa* (hearing), *manana* (reflection), and *nididhyāsana* (deep meditation) together constitute the mode of *upāsanā* - contemplative worship. The deity who is to be realized through these three processes is likened to the *ākāśa* (ether), for just as the sky delights Indra, so too does the Supreme Being (*Paramātman*) become glorified through these sacred acts of cognition.
Through the vibrations of sound emanating from these practices of hearing, reflection, and meditation, the aspirant becomes profoundly inspired (*prerita*). Thus, sound itself serves as the medium through which

the consciousness ascends toward divine awareness, mirroring the expansive and all-pervasive nature of the *ākāśa* that both reveals and sustains the Supreme.

Proposition:
Dialogue on Divine Inspiration

- **Question:** Who inspires?
  Answer: The deity presiding over this mantra is *Pavamāna Soma*; therefore, it is this deity who acts as the inspirer.
- **Question:** Whom does he inspire?
  Answer: He inspires the *Upāsanīya* or the one who is meditating.
- **Question:** How does he inspire?
  Answer: He awakens within the *Upāsanīya* the threefold processes of *śravaṇa* (listening to the truth), *manana* (contemplative reflection), and *nididhyāsana* (profound meditation).
- **Question:** For whose sake does he inspire?
  Answer: For the sake of *Indra*, who is as expansive as the sky (*ākāśa*), and for the *Paramātman* (Supreme Self), who is as blissful and all-pervading as the sky itself.

Conclusion of Method-4:
A state arises in which the individual becomes aware of himself as an integral part of creation.
Only those imaginations (*ūha*) that correspond to the three bodies emerge in that state.
This awareness, *self-recognition within creation* is the defining characteristic of human existence. It is **consciousness itself**, whose essential nature lies in the act of **self-knowing**.

Method-5:
RigVēda (7-38-8)

- देवता**:** वाजिनः
- ऋषि**:** वसिष्ठः
- छन्द**:** निचृत्त्रिष्टुप्
- स्वर**:** धैवतः

वाजे॑वाजेऽवत वाजिनो नो॒ धने॑षु॒ विप्रा अमृता ऋतज्ञाः। अ॒स्य मध्वः॑ पिबत मा॒दय॑ध्वं तृ॒प्ता या॑त प॒थिभि॑र्देव॒यानैः॑ ॥८॥

Essence of RigVēda (7-38-8):
May the immortal truth and wisdom, together with those endowed with great knowledge, strength, and intellect, protect us in every battle concerning the pursuit of wealth.
Let Him, who grants the sweet essence of this divine knowledge as a drink of bliss, gladden and satisfy us, and proceed along the celestial paths borne by radiant vehicles.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who attains the path of the Devas (*Devayāna-mārga*)?
  Answer: Those who possess true knowledge (*satya-jñānins*).
- **Question:** Who are the protectors in every battle?
  Answer: The wise ones endowed with manifold knowledge, strength, and swiftness of intellect.
- **Question:** What is the nature of the knowledge possessed by the wise?
  Answer: It is the immortal and truthful knowledge that transcends death.
- **Question:** Whom do the knowers of truth bring satisfaction to?
  Answer: To the wise themselves.
- **Question:** What does “protection in every battle” signify?
  Answer: It signifies the act of gladdening the wise through the various paths of knowledge.
- **Question:** How do the wise, endowed with great knowledge, strength, and insight, protect the operation of true knowledge?

Answer: By performing the tapas (spiritual discipline) that safeguards the right application of the meaning of the *Vēdākṣaras* (*akṣarārtha-yoga*), thus upholding the order of true knowledge.

Conclusion of Method-5:
The unification of the meanings of the *Vēdākṣaras* (*akṣarārtha-yoga*) itself constitutes *tapas* (spiritual discipline or austerity). In the Vedic mantras, the repeated expressions *tapa* and *tapyata* serve as constant exhortations toward this practice. This subject of inquiry has been examined and demonstrated with reference to the RigVēda (7-38-8) mantra.

Method-6:
RigVēda (10-25-6)

- देवता**:** सोमः
- ऋषि**:** विमद ऐन्द्रः प्राजापत्यो वा वसुकृद्वा वासुक्रः
- छन्द**:** आस्तारपङ्क्ति
- स्वर**:** पञ्चमः

प॒शुं नः॑ सोम रक्षसि पु॒रु॒त्रा विष्ठि॑तं॒ जग॑त् । स॒माकृ॑णोषि जी॒वसे॒ वि वो॒ मदे॒ विश्वा॑ स॒म्पश्य॒न्भुव॑ना॒ विव॑क्षसे ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-25-6):
O Soma! Protect us through one who beholds all with equal vision, the one who has repeatedly vowed with distinction, who perceives the entirety of the worlds with clarity. Thou dost establish the right order that sustains life. May that Supreme Being keep you in exalted joy and blessedness.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who is the deity of this mantra, Soma?
  Answer: He is the one who regards all beings with equal vision and protects the one who has made a distinguished vow.
- **Question:** In this mantra, who are referred to as “all”?
  Answer: Those endowed with flowers (Puṣpavān), progeny (Prajāvān), and cattle (Paśumān).
- **Question:** What does Soma do?
  Answer: He establishes a harmonious order in the world, enabling all to live with distinction.
- **Question:** Who is the one that beholds all the worlds with perfect vision?
  Answer: The Supreme Being (Paramātman).

Conclusion of Method-6:
This mantra conveys that those who, having taken a distinguished vow, regard all beings with equal vision, seek from the Supreme Being (Paramātman) that the world may be established in an excellent and harmonious order, enabling all to live with distinction and joy in all realms of existence.
Through this mantra, it is taught that in every sacrificial act (yajña), the fruits manifest as *Puṣpavān* (abundance of flowers or prosperity), *Prajāvān* (offspring or progeny), and *Paśumān* (possession of cattle or wealth in living beings).

Conclusion:
The present study demonstrates that the cultivation of divine consciousness (*deva-bhāva*) involves the harmonious integration of the mind (*manas*), knowledge (*jñāna*), and senses (*indriyāṇi*) with the divine power of Indra (*Indra-devatā-śakti*), symbolically represented by the moon (*candra*). By awakening this power, thoughts imbued with divine awareness guide human conduct, as thoughts constitute the primary causes of action (*kāraṇa of pravṛtti*). Systematic contemplation (*tapas*) of the Vedic syllables (*akṣaras*) including their sounds, pronunciation, reflection, and meaning, transforms these thoughts into orderly discipline through the sacrificial practice of yajña.
The vital force (*prāṇa*) enunciates the primordial syllables while the mind conceives them, connecting human faculties to the generative energy (*āpaśśakti*) underlying creation. This connection enables the

manifestation of life and prosperity and fosters a state of self-realization, wherein the individual recognizes himself as an integral part of creation, giving rise to thoughts corresponding to the three bodies (*tridhātu dehas*). The unification of syllable meanings (*akṣarārtha-yoga*) constitutes spiritual discipline (*tapas*), consistently reinforced in Vedic mantras. Furthermore, Vedic injunctions teach that a world guided by equitable vision and divine order yields abundance, progeny, and wealth (*Puṣpavān, Prajāvān, Paśumān*), highlighting the profound interrelationship between consciousness, action, and cosmic harmony.

References:

(1). RigVēda (1-103-1)
(2). RigVēda (10-71-2)
(3). RigVēda (1-75-2)
(4). RigVēda (9-34-4)
(5). RigVēda (7-38-8)
(6). RigVēda (10-25-6)